ADVANCE MARKETING MANAGEMENT

REPORT ON MARKETING STRATEGY REPORT FOR YOUTH RELEVANCE AND CATEGORY EXPANSION

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We express our gratitude to our faculty at FIIB Delhi for guiding us throughout the Marketing Hackathon project. Their direction and support helped us approach this assignment with clarity and a deeper understanding of marketing strategy.

We also acknowledge **Flying Machine** as the focal brand of this study, along with the insights gained from market visits, customer observations, and secondary research. Finally, we appreciate the collaborative effort of all team members whose contributions shaped this report.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report examines Flying Machine's current position in the Indian youth fashion market and highlights challenges affecting its relevance among Gen Z and young millennials. Primary observations from the Connaught Place, Delhi store showed that customers mainly engaged with denim products while other categories such as shirts and jackets lacked variety, freshness and visual appeal. Secondary research revealed that the brand also struggles to keep pace with fast moving trends that influence young consumers. Digital engagement on platforms like Instagram is lower than competing brands and the store environment does not reflect the energy or style expected by today's youth.

Competitor analysis, particularly with H&M, shows that Flying Machine faces strong competition from global fast fashion brands that offer wider assortment depth, trend driven collections, and strong digital storytelling. These gaps limit Flying Machine's ability to attract and retain young shoppers.

The report integrates findings from field research, secondary insights and market analysis using PESTLE and SWOT frameworks. It proposes strategic actions focused on improving product variety beyond denim, refreshing trend alignment, strengthening digital presence, and enhancing in store presentation. The recommendations aim to rebuild Flying Machine's appeal among its core audience and support stronger growth across categories.

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1.INTRODUCTION

The Indian youth fashion and denim market is evolving rapidly, driven by the rising influence of Gen Z, increased digital adoption, and fast-fashion trends. Flying Machine India's first homegrown denim label once enjoyed strong brand loyalty but is now facing relevance challenges in a marketplace dominated by global fast-fashion players.

The shift towards digital-first discovery, trend-led purchase decisions, and omnichannel experience expectations has reshaped how young consumers engage with fashion brands. Based on field insights, secondary research, and competitor benchmarking, the brand requires strategic repositioning to strengthen appeal among digitally native youth audiences.

2.COMPANY OVERVIEW

Flying Machine, part of Arvind Fashions Ltd., established in 1980, is India's first indigenous denim brand. Known for affordable casualwear and contemporary denim innovation, the brand historically maintained strong retail presence and was a preferred choice for young consumers.

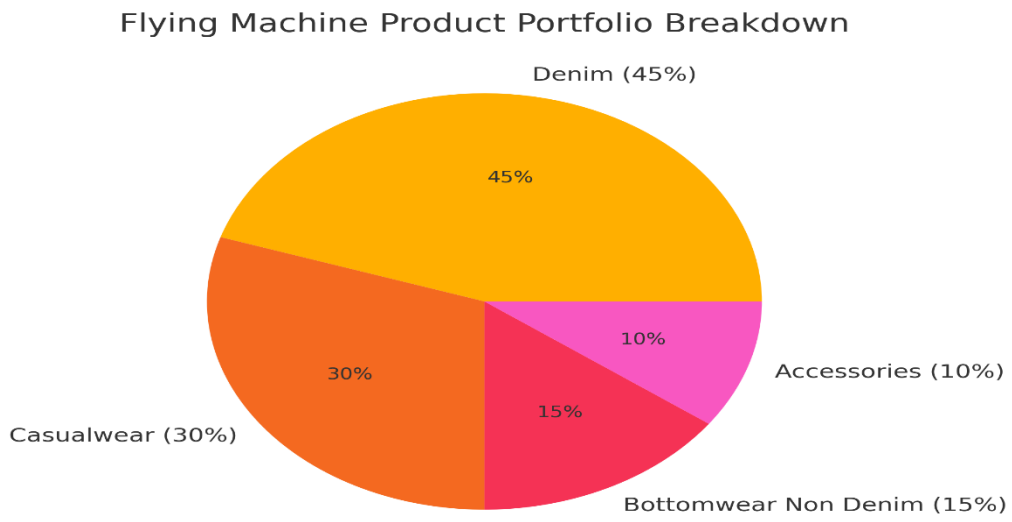
Key Highlights

- Strong heritage and credibility in Indian denim culture
- Extensive presence across exclusive stores and multi-brand outlets
- Affordable pricing with broad categories: denim, casualwear, accessories
- Weakening traction among Gen Z due to rapidly evolving fashion expectations
- Limited trend agility and under-optimized digital engagement

Today, the brand must evolve from a legacy denim label into a youth-centric, online-first fast-fashion brand to compete effectively.

3.PRODUCT PORTFOLIO BREAKDOWN

Category	Contribution Estimate	Description
Denim	45%	Core heritage category with strong brand recall
Casualwear	30%	Trend driven daily wear including tees, shirts, hoodies
Bottomwear Non denim	15%	Cargos, joggers, chinos
Accessories	10%	Wallets, belts, bags, caps



4. COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

4.1 Competitive Landscape Mapping

Flying Machine operates in a highly competitive youth fashion ecosystem shaped by global fast fashion leaders, established domestic apparel brands, and fast rising digital first challengers. Instead of competing with a single dominant player, Flying Machine must navigate a multi layered landscape that influences both fashion trends and consumer expectations.

The competitive environment includes:

- **Global fast fashion brands** that set trend direction (H&M, ZARA, Urbanic)
- **Domestic youth-fashion brands** offering value pricing (Roadster, Highlander, HRX)
- **Online-first D2C brands** creating trend speed and viral fashion cycles (Bewakoof, Snitch, The Souled Store)

Within this landscape, **H&M** emerges as Flying Machine's strongest direct competitor due to similar target demographics, overlapping fashion categories, and shared presence in metro cities.

4.2 PRIMARY DIRECT COMPETITOR

Competitor 1: H&M (Hennes & Mauritz)



H&M represents the most formidable direct competitor to Flying Machine. Both brands target urban youth and early professionals, yet H&M leads in trend responsiveness, digital influence, and store experience. Flying Machine retains strength in denim heritage but struggles to match H&M's fashion diversity and brand appeal.

4.3 COMPARATIVE PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS: FLYING MACHINE VS H&M

Metric	Flying Machine	H&M	Competitive Position
Market Scale (India)	Mid sized youth apparel player	Large global fast fashion brand	H&M leads in scale and influence
Category Strength	Strong in denim	Strong across all fashion categories	H&M leads in variety breadth
Trend Responsiveness	Moderate, slower cycles	Very fast, weekly new drops	H&M leads in trend agility
Store Ambience	Compact, functional layout	Spacious, vibrant, youth centric	H&M delivers stronger experience

Metric	Flying Machine	H&M	Competitive Position
Digital Presence	Emerging	Highly developed	H&M leads in influencer marketing and reels
Pricing Strategy	Affordable, full price focus	Competitive, frequent capsule pricing	Comparable, but H&M offers more perceived value
Footfall (CP Market)	Lower and limited	High and continuous	H&M leads due to brand pull

4.4 ANALYTICAL INSIGHTS

Product Differentiation Lens

- H&M offers wide assortments across tees, oversized fits, cargos, jackets, athleisure, and streetwear.
- Flying Machine remains denim centric, causing lower exploration across other categories.

Digital Competence Lens

- H&M dominates Instagram with consistent reels, fashion drops, and creator led content.
- Flying Machine’s digital visibility and engagement are significantly lower, limiting youth recall.

Consumer Appeal Lens

H&M appeals strongly to fashion aware Gen Z consumers seeking expressive, trend forward styles. Flying Machine appeals to value conscious, denim oriented customers but loses relevance in lifestyle and trend driven wardrobes.

5. FIELD VISIT INSIGHTS (PRIMARY RESEARCH)

Primary research was conducted at the Flying Machine store in Connaught Place, New Delhi, with a focus on assessing customer behaviour, store ambience, staff engagement, product display, and pricing practices. The store offered a clean and organised layout; however, its visual merchandising appeared more traditional than what today's youth-centric fashion brands typically showcase. Footfall was steady among individuals aged nineteen to thirty-five, yet conversion levels remained modest, suggesting that interest did not consistently translate into purchase intent.

A notable insight from the visit was Flying Machine's emphasis on selling only fresh and newly arrived stock. Store staff confirmed that discounts are rarely offered, as the brand prioritises current-season inventory. This strategy reinforces a premium and freshness-focused positioning centred on consistent pricing rather than promotional markdowns.

To evaluate this positioning in context, pricing patterns on multi-brand platforms such as Ajio, Myntra, Pantaloons, and Lifestyle were reviewed. These platforms routinely offer discounts because they often sell older or past-season stock as part of their inventory clearance structure. Although customers benefit from reduced prices, they do not always receive the latest collections. This contrast clearly differentiates Flying Machine as a fresh-stock brand, while multi-brand retailers operate on a discount-led model.

Customer behavior in-store reflected high price consciousness. Several shoppers compared online prices before making a decision, and many hesitated to purchase at full price despite showing interest. This indicates that the absence of discounts may be a barrier for value-driven youth customers accustomed to ongoing promotions on e-commerce platforms.

Staff interaction was polite yet minimal, with limited efforts to guide customers or highlight new arrivals.





REFLECTION ON PRIMARY RESEARCH

The Connaught Place visit underscored a distinct gap between Flying Machine's premium, fresh-inventory positioning and the discount-oriented expectations shaped by online platforms. While the brand benefits from offering updated collections, strengthening in-store engagement and enhancing value communication will be essential to improve conversion among today's digitally informed, price-sensitive youth segment.

6. SECONDARY RESEARCH FINDINGS

An extensive review of online resources such as customer reviews on Myntra, Amazon, Google Maps, and social media platforms revealed several insights. Many customers appreciate the durability of Flying Machine denim but feel the brand is not evolving quickly enough to match Gen Z trends. Online engagement levels on Instagram and YouTube are considerably lower than competitor brands. Customer comments highlight inconsistency in product fits and a desire for more trend-based designs.

Industry reports show that the youth fashion segment in India is evolving rapidly, with strong demand for oversized fits, pastel colours, sustainable fabrics, and fast-fashion trends. Brands with bold digital identities and strong influencer partnerships are currently performing better.

7. PESTLE ANALYSIS

Political:

India's apparel retail sector operates under stable regulatory policies that support ease of doing business. Consistent GST structures and government support for textile manufacturing provide a predictable environment for brands like Flying Machine to operate and expand.

Economic:

Young consumers are highly price sensitive due to the dominance of online platforms offering frequent discounts. Economic fluctuations influence discretionary spending, and shoppers increasingly compare offline prices with e commerce offers before making a purchase.

Social:

Youth fashion preferences are strongly shaped by global trends, influencer culture, and digital communities. Gen Z expects variety, constant freshness, and expressive designs. Their fashion choices are closely linked to identity and social image, making trend alignment crucial for brands.

Technological:

Rapid digitalisation demands integration of technology within retail formats. Customers expect features such as QR codes for product information, digital trial screens, and seamless omnichannel experiences. Brands that adopt digital tools gain higher engagement and operational efficiency.

Legal:

Fashion retailers must comply with consumer protection standards, textile labelling norms, and pricing

transparency guidelines. Adhering to these legal requirements is essential for building trust and avoiding regulatory penalties.

Environmental:
There is increasing awareness about sustainability among young shoppers who seek eco friendly fabrics, ethical production, and responsible fashion communication. Brands that adopt sustainable practices can improve their overall brand image and long term customer loyalty.

8. SWOT ANALYSIS

Strengths:
Flying Machine has a strong heritage in denim, which gives it high recall and credibility among Indian consumers. Its pricing remains accessible, allowing it to compete effectively in the mid value youth fashion segment. The brand also benefits from widespread availability across online and offline channels**.**

Weaknesses:
The brand's variety outside denim is limited, which reduces overall fashion appeal and restricts customer exploration across categories. Its digital presence and influencer involvement are weaker compared to fast fashion competitors. Visual merchandising also lacks freshness needed to attract trend driven youth.

Opportunities:
There is significant potential for expanding trend based collections such as oversized fits, cargos, streetwear, and seasonal capsules. Collaborations with influencers and stylists can strengthen brand visibility and engagement on platforms like Instagram and YouTube. Growing digital adoption provides opportunities to build a stronger online community around the brand.

Threats:
Fast fashion brands such as H&M and Urbanic introduce new styles rapidly, creating high expectations among youth. These brands also dominate trend cycles and social media visibility. The fast pace of fashion trends poses a challenge for Flying Machine, which currently operates with slower design and merchandising cycles.

9. IDENTIFICATION OF THE CORE MARKETING CHALLENGE

Core Marketing Challenge

Flying Machine is losing relevance among Gen Z consumers due to weak trend responsiveness, outdated store experience, and limited digital influence.
This insight emerges from both primary field research and secondary digital reviews.

Key Issue Drivers

1. **Weak Trend Alignment**
    - Customers report designs feel outdated compared to H&M, ZARA, Urbanic.
2. **Low Digital Influence**
    - Low Instagram engagement, limited influencer presence.
3. **Outdated Store Experience**
    - Visual merchandising lacks vibrancy expected by Gen Z.
4. **Pricing Perception Gap**
    - In-store fresh stock at full price vs. discounted past-season stock online confuses customers.
5. **Fragmented Brand Communication**
    - No strong brand narrative, story, or trend-led campaigns.

10. TARGET MARKET

Persona 1: Digital Gen Z (Age 16–24)

Profile:
Digitally native, socially expressive, highly influenced by short-form content and micro-trends.

Key Traits:

- Trend-focused and actively follows influencers and campus fashion
- Price-conscious but willing to pay for styles that feel current
- Engages primarily through Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts
- Seeks statement clothing that reflects individuality

Style Preferences:
Oversized silhouettes, cargo pants, varsity jackets, graphic tees, and streetwear-inspired fits

Persona 2: Urban Millennials (Age 25–30)

Profile:
Young professionals balancing functional fashion with personal style.

Key Traits:

- Looks for quality, comfort, and versatility in everyday wear
- Follows brand reputation and product reviews before purchasing
- Shops across both physical stores and online platforms
- Values consistency in fit, durability, and brand reliability

Style Preferences:
Smart casualwear, refined denims, structured shirts, minimalistic jackets

11. RESEARCH APPROACH

The research methodology followed a structured approach consisting of field visits, online observation, competitor analysis, and secondary data review. The field visit helped identify experiential gaps, while online analysis highlighted sentiment trends and brand perceptions. Competitor benchmarking provided clarity on the strategies of leading fast-fashion brands. Collectively, these insights formed the foundation for designing the final marketing strategy.

12.STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES

Short-Term Objectives (0–6 Months)
Focused on building momentum, improving visibility, and establishing a strong trend-first direction.

Objective 1: Improve Instagram engagement by 40%

How:

- Launch weekly trend-led reel series featuring campus creators
- Use micro-influencers to showcase new drops in natural, real-life settings
- Create "Get Ready With Me (GRWM)" styling content
- Use interactive formats like polls, quizzes, and fit-rating stories

Success Indicators:
Engagement rate, reach per reel, follower growth

Objective 2: Increase in-store conversion by 10%

How:

- Introduce curated "New Drop Zones" near store entrance
- Add QR-linked styling ideas to shelves
- Train staff to communicate value (fresh stock, fit quality, new styles)
- Improve lighting & mannequins to highlight trend fits

Success Indicators:
Footfall-to-purchase ratio, average bill value

Objective 3: Launch trend-led micro-collections ("Fashion Drops")

How:

- Release monthly capsule collections inspired by viral trends
- Promote drops heavily through reels, influencer try-ons, and lookbooks
- Add countdown features on social media and website
- Create limited-stock urgency

Success Indicators:
Sell-through rate, repeat purchase rate

Medium-Term Objectives (6–18 Months)

Focused on building deeper brand relevance and strengthening Flying Machine's youth appeal.

Objective 4: Strengthen the influencer ecosystem

How:

- Build a network of 150–200 micro-influencers across major campuses
- Partner with mid-tier fashion creators for seasonal campaigns
- Create creator-led community events in malls and colleges
- Launch a "Flying Machine Creator Program" for year-round collaborations

Success Indicators:
Influencer-generated content volume, cost per engagement, campaign ROI

Objective 5: Introduce limited-edition collaborations

How:

- Collaborate with young Indian designers and illustrators
- Release co-branded collections with cultural icons (music, gaming, street art)
- Introduce exclusive packaging and storytelling for collabs

Success Indicators:
Collection sell-out time, media coverage, brand sentiment

Objective 6: Upgrade in-store experience

How:

- Add digital trial mirrors for virtual try-ons
- Create Instagrammable corners aligned with brand attitude
- Introduce music and lighting that appeal to Gen Z aesthetics
- Rework visual merchandising to highlight streetwear and youth styling

Success Indicators:
Store dwell time, visual merchandising score, customer satisfaction rating

Long-Term Objectives (18–24 Months)

Focused on building a future-ready, digitally engaged, loyal youth community.

Objective 7: Establish Flying Machine as "India's Youth-Style Brand"

How:

- Large-scale national youth campaign
- Position Flying Machine around self-expression, confidence, and individuality
- Sponsor college festivals, music events, and cultural collaborations

Success Indicators:
Brand recall studies, youth preference index

Objective 8: Reduce dependence on discounting

How:

- Improve trend value so customers buy full-price drops
- Introduce loyalty rewards instead of discounts
- Align pricing consistency across online and offline channels

Success Indicators:
Full-price sell-through, gross margin improvement

Objective 9: Build a strong digital community

How:

- Launch app-based loyalty program
- Create Flying Machine “Style Club” for exclusive perks
- Encourage UGC through monthly styling contests
- Offer early access to drops for community members

Success Indicators:
Loyalty sign-ups, UGC volume, repeat purchase rate.

13. MARKETING MIX STRATEGY

Product

The brand should introduce more trend-focused clothing, including oversized T-shirts, cargo pants, varsity jackets, and limited-edition monthly "fashion drops." Incorporating sustainable fabrics such as organic cotton or recycled denim can further enhance appeal. Collaborations with young designers and illustrators can help create exclusive designs that feel fresh and relevant.

Price

The pricing structure should remain competitive while placing more emphasis on value. Student discounts, bundled offers, and loyalty pricing can attract repeat customers. The pricing should be consistent across online and offline channels to reduce confusion.

Place

Flying Machine should strengthen its presence on major e-commerce platforms and improve visual presentation on these sites. Physical stores should be redesigned to offer a more youthful and interactive experience. Introducing digital trial mirrors, QR-linked styling suggestions, and Instagram-friendly corners would help create a modern retail environment.

Promotion

A stronger digital communication strategy is essential. Collaborations with micro-influencers and campus creators can significantly boost engagement. Campaigns such as "Style Your Denim," "College Fits Challenge," or a monthly reel contest can encourage user-generated content. Social media content should highlight expressive styling, everyday youth fashion, and real customers wearing the brand.

14.PROPOSED BUDGET

Activity	**Budget Allocation**
Influencer Marketing	₹8,00,000
In-store Visual Revamp	₹5,50,000
Social Media Ads	₹4,00,000
Loyalty Program Setup	₹2,50,000
Seasonal Collection Shoots	₹3,00,000
Total Budget	**₹23,00,000**

15. PERFORMANCE METRICS

Digital Metrics

- 40% increase in Instagram engagement
- 25% increase in website/app traffic
- 2x rise in UGC via #DenimYourWay

Sales Metrics

- 15% increase in denim sales
- 10% increase in conversion at physical stores
- 30% loyalty program signup rate

Brand Metrics

- Improved brand recall among college students (survey-based)
- Higher customer satisfaction ratings on Google Reviews & Myntra

16. CONCLUSION

Flying Machine remains a significant name in India's denim and youth fashion landscape, supported by strong brand heritage and nationwide presence. However, the rapidly evolving preferences of Gen Z and young millennials require the brand to modernize its approach and strengthen its relevance in an increasingly digital and trend driven market.

The insights gathered through field observations, secondary research, and competitive analysis highlight the need for a focused transformation across digital engagement, trend responsiveness, and in store experience. By adopting a youth centric brand narrative, introducing fast moving micro collections, strengthening influencer partnerships, and elevating the retail environment, Flying Machine can reposition itself as a contemporary and aspirational fashion brand.

The strategic recommendations outlined in this report provide a structured roadmap for driving this transformation. Successful execution will enable Flying Machine to enhance its market competitiveness, improve customer engagement, and build a stronger emotional connection with the new generation of fashion-conscious consumers. Ultimately, these efforts will help the brand reclaim leadership in India's youth style category and secure sustainable long-term growth.

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